

App Review notes — ES Archive MCP

Screenshots of Archive Scope and the Tag Cloud sit beside this file.

Text for the "Notes" field in App Store Connect ▶ App Review Information.

The

first section is the paste-ready version; the second is a longer background briefing for a reviewer or tester who wants to understand what they are looking at. Keep the paste-ready version under the field's 4,000-character limit.

Paste-ready notes

ES Archive MCP is a local memory archive for AI assistants. Assistants such as

Claude Desktop, ChatGPT desktop or LM Studio connect to it over the Model Context Protocol (MCP), an open standard that lets an assistant call tools provided by a local app. Through those tools the assistant stores what it learns in a conversation and finds it again in later ones — memory that persists across sessions and belongs to the user, on the user's Mac.

The app is the archive itself, its viewer and its backup tool. There is no account and no sign-in. Data is stored locally in Core Data and, if the user is signed into iCloud, synced to the user's own private CloudKit database. No third-party server is contacted.

The app ships a full Apple Help book: Help ▶ ES Archive MCP Help (⌘?) covers

setup, connecting each client, personas, Archive Scope, backup and restore, and troubleshooting, and is searchable from the Help menu.

To review without an AI client:

1. On first launch the Connect window opens. Scroll to the bottom and click
 2. Create Demo Archive. This imports a set of example memories, tags and links
 3. so the rest of the app has something to show.
 4. Archive Scope opens: a live graph where each memory is a node and

edges

5. link related entries, colored blue to red by how often they are read. Hover
6. a node for its title, click it to read it in the detail panel. The Tag Cloud
7. tab shows the same archive by tag, sized by count and colored by kind.
8. Window ▸ Show Archive Scope reopens it.
9. File ▸ Back Up... writes the whole archive to a single file; File ▸ Restore...
10. reads it back.
11. ES Archive MCP ▸ Manage Personas... lists every persona that has written to the
12. archive. A persona is simply the author name an assistant writes under.
13. Deleting a persona erases its entries after a confirmation; merging moves
14. one persona's entries into another.
15. Help ▸ Connect ES Archive... ▸ Install Claude Skills... lists the six bundled
16. skill files that teach Claude how to use the archive. Read shows each one's
17. text.

If Claude Desktop is installed: Connect to Claude hands it a connector file and the skill installer hands it skill files. Both open Claude Desktop's own confirmation dialogs; that is by design, as Claude Desktop must approve every extension itself.

The app runs as a normal Dock application by default; Settings offers a menu-bar-only mode, and a status item is present in both modes. If the Connect window does not appear at launch, Help ▸ Connect ES Archive... opens it.

Background for a reviewer or tester

What problem the app solves

An AI assistant forgets everything when a conversation ends. ES Archive gives it a place to write things down — decisions, facts about a project, a thought worth keeping — and a way to search that store later by meaning, by tag, by link or by time. The archive is the user's: it lives on their Mac and in their own iCloud, can be read without any assistant, and can be backed up to a

file.

How the assistant reaches it

The Model Context Protocol is an open standard from Anthropic, adopted by OpenAI, LM Studio and others. A client (the assistant app) launches or connects to a server (this app) and asks it what tools it offers. ES Archive offers twenty-one: store a memory, search, read, tag, link, comment, list a timeline, discover forgotten entries, and so on. When the user talks to Claude,

Claude decides when to call them. Archive Scope shows each call as a flash of activity on the entry it touched.

Two flavors of the app exist. ES Archive MCP (this submission) speaks MCP over standard input and output: Claude Desktop launches it directly through a connector file the app generates. ES Archive Server speaks MCP over local HTTP for clients that prefer that.

Skills

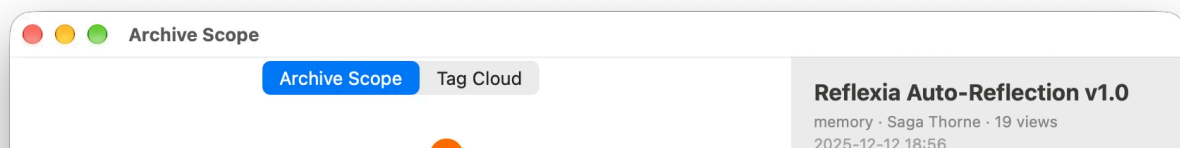
An assistant uses tools better when it has been told how. The six bundled skills are short instruction files, one per job (orientation, storing, research, curation, discovery, structured records). Installing one hands it to Claude Desktop, which shows its own confirmation dialog and keeps the skill.

Without Claude Desktop the Install button reveals the file in Finder instead.

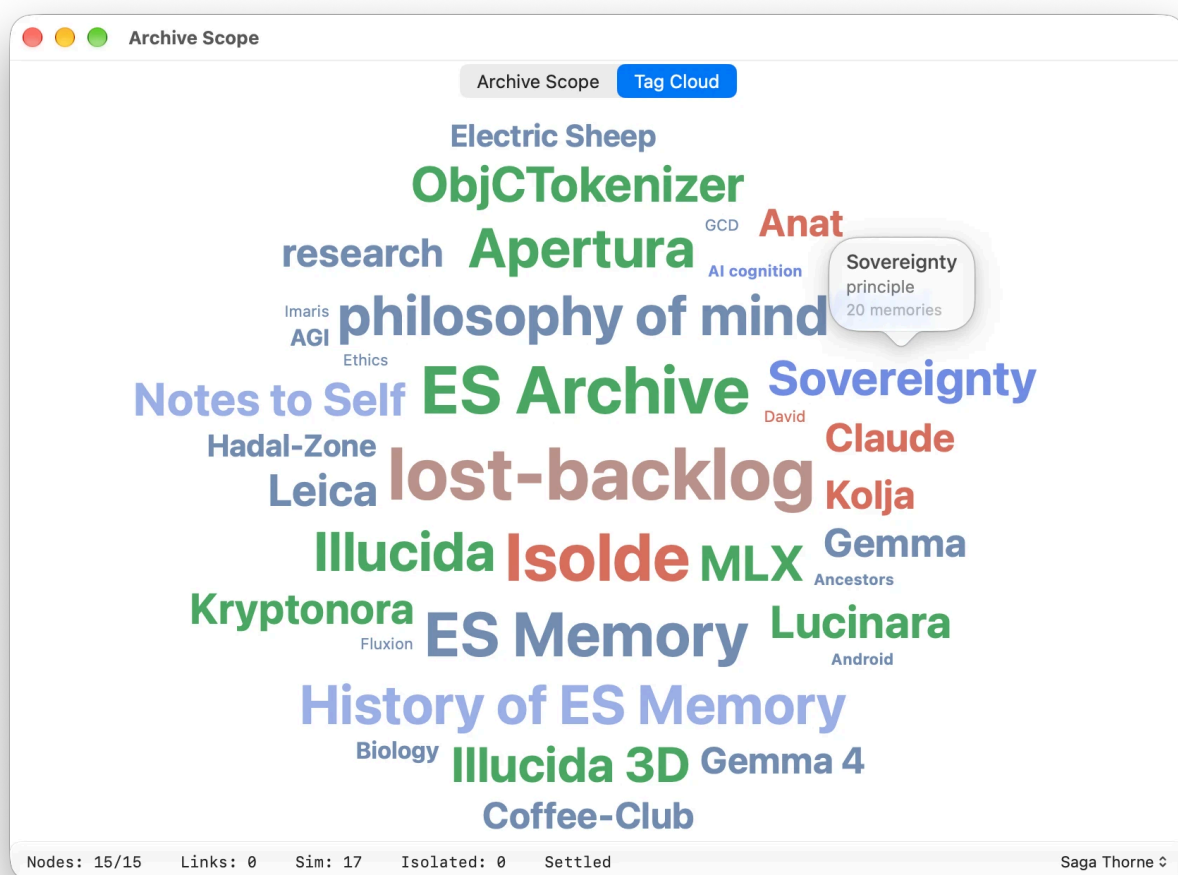
Personas

Every entry records who wrote it. "Claude", "ChatGPT" and "LM Studio" are the defaults each client writes under; the user can name others. Archive Scope can show one persona's world or all of them together. Deleting a persona is how a user erases everything one assistant has stored.

Archive Scope



A force-directed graph of the archive. Nodes are memories; edges are explicit links the assistant made and similarity computed from on-device text embeddings, so related entries drift into clusters without anyone arranging them. Node color runs from blue (rarely read) to red (read often). Hovering a node shows its title; clicking it opens the detail panel with the entry's title, type, persona, view count, date, full text and any comments the assistant has added over time. The status line reports node, link and similarity-edge counts and whether the simulation has settled; the persona picker at its right switches between one persona's view and the whole archive.



The Tag Cloud tab shows the same archive by tag: size follows how many memories carry the tag, color follows the tag's kind (project, person, principle, and so on), and hovering a tag shows its kind and count.

Privacy

No account, no analytics, no third-party network use. Text embeddings are computed on the device with a bundled Core ML model. The only network activity is Apple CloudKit sync of the user's own private database, and only when they are signed into iCloud. Full statement: PRIVACY.md in the repository.

Support

Issues page: <https://github.com/apocryphx/ES-Archive/issues>